

MAHAKUMBH NAGAR A bird's-eye view of the sprawling tent city spread over 4,000 hectares on the sandbanks of the Ganga

29	40	11	12km	8km
Temples beautified	Junctions, 48 roads spruced up	Corridors developed	Temporary ghats built	Riverfront roads laid out

This synthesis of heritage and innovation has been at work for months—literally plotting the action. The whole gargantuan process of land and service allotments was digitised this time, eliminating the fuzzy inefficiencies of manual coordination. The Prayagraj Mela Authority used GIS-based mapping and high-resolution drone surveys to prepare layouts for the 25 sectors of the mela. Conducted before and after the monsoon, these generated georeferenced maps with 0.5 cm accuracy, ensuring precise land allocations. The authority also digitised data from 5,500 institutions that participated in 2019 and integrated it with online applications from new participants. Over 10,000 entities—the various sadhu congregations called *akhadas*, spiritual/cultural organisations, government departments—have benefited from this marvel of modern logistics. Permits for services and amenities, too, have been digitised, allowing seamless coordination between institutions, vendors